



TimeGate

Recording staff clock-in, clock-out and break times. A guide for the manager running it.

Nothing in this guide needs any technical knowledge.
Prepared for review · September 2026

What it does

Staff clock in and out with a 4-digit code, on the tablet at the entrance or on their own phone.

A normal day is four taps: **clock in**, **start break**, **end break**, **clock out**. Breaks can be taken as often as needed — tea and lunch are both just breaks.

 TimeGate

17:37
Monday 14 September

Enter your code

Your 4-digit code

1

2

3

4

5

6

7

8

9

Clear

0



The screen staff see. They enter their own 4-digit code — nothing else.

Two things to decide before you rely on it

1. Staff can clock in from anywhere

There is no check that someone is at the workplace. Anybody who has the punch link and their own code can clock in from home, from the bus, from bed.

The old tablet-on-the-wall arrangement stopped that by being a physical object in a physical place. This does not, and no amount of software will: a phone cannot prove where it is without tracking where your staff are, which is a much bigger decision than a timesheet.

WHAT YOU HAVE INSTEAD

Every punch has a name on it and appears on your Records screen the same day. If someone's hours look wrong, you can see exactly when they clocked in and ask about it. That is a management control, not a technical one — worth being clear with the team that you can see it.

If this matters more than convenience, keep the punch link on the entrance tablet only and do not send it to anyone.

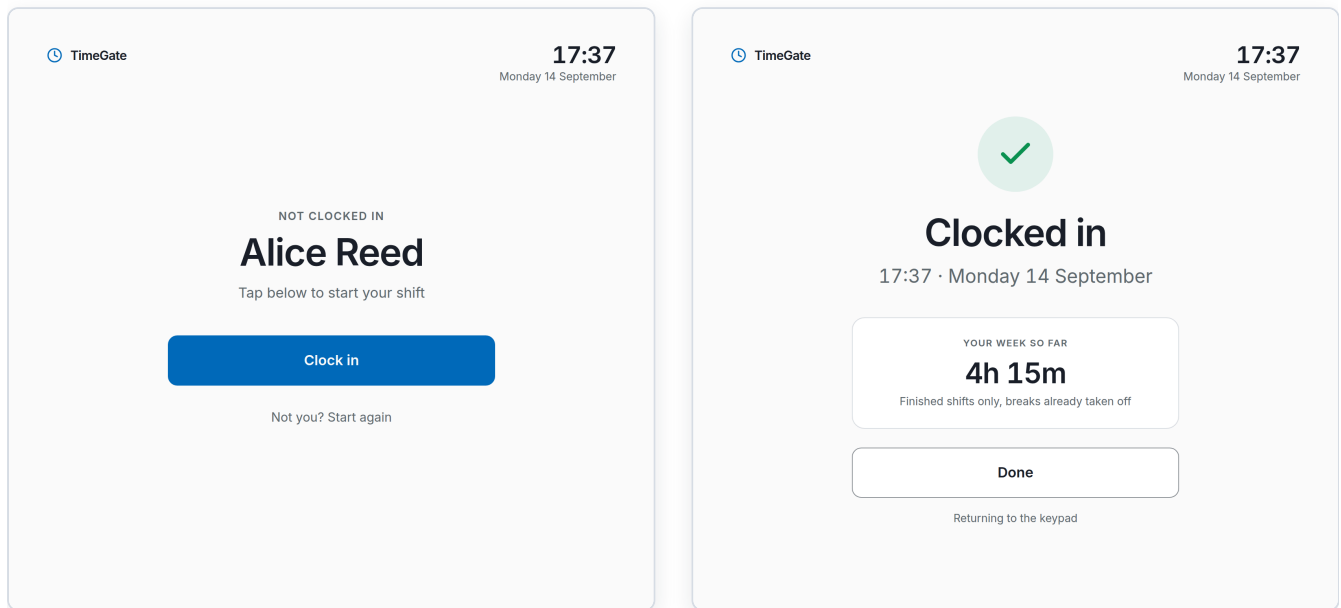
2. Breaks are unpaid

Break time is subtracted from the hours you pay. A 09:00–17:00 day with a 15-minute break pays **7 h 45 m**, not 8 hours.

This was confirmed as how you pay, and it is built in. If it is ever wrong, say so *before* a payroll run rather than after — it changes every shift.

What a staff member sees

They enter their code, the screen greets them by name and offers only what makes sense next — someone already clocked in is not offered "clock in" again.



Left: after entering a code. Right: the confirmation, which returns to the keypad by itself after a few seconds so the next person never sees a colleague's hours.

The confirmation shows their week so far, with breaks already deducted. Most questions about hours get answered here rather than reaching you.

Adding someone

On **Staff** → *Add a staff member*. You will see their code **once**. It cannot be shown again, so send it before you close the panel. If it gets lost, issue a new one — the old one stops working immediately.

TimeGate

Today

Records

Staff

Staff

4 people

+ Add a staff member

NAME	PAYROLL REF	STATUS	ACTIONS
Alice Reed	TG-101	Active	New code Mark as left
Ben Shaw	TG-102	Active	New code Mark as left
Cara Diaz	TG-103	Left	Reactivate
Dana Okoro	TG-104	Active	New code Mark as left

Marking someone as left stops their code working. It never removes them from a week they already worked — those hours still export.

AK Aisha Karim

Manager

The Staff screen. A newly issued code appears at the top, once.

Send them one message with both halves:

Hi [name] — clock in and out here: [punch link]
Your code is [1234]. Keep it to yourself.
Save the link to your home screen and it is one tap from then on.

Codes are private. Two people sharing one means two people's hours under one name.

When someone leaves

Staff → *Mark as left*. Their code stops working straight away. Their existing hours are untouched: they still appear in that week's export, and they still get paid for what they worked.

Fixing a forgotten punch

People forget to clock out. It will happen in the first week.

Those shifts appear on **Records** marked **Needs review**, with **0:00** payable and a banner above the table. The real times they did record are kept exactly as they are — nothing is guessed.

TimeGate

Today

Records

Staff

Records

Mon 7 Sept — Sun 13 Sept

< This week >

Export CSV

1 shift need a look before you export

They are still in the CSV, with their real times and zero hours, so nobody is paid short without it showing.

PAYABLE THIS WEEK

21:30

21.50 hours

UNPAID BREAKS

1:00

Deducted from payable

SHIFTS

4

1 need review

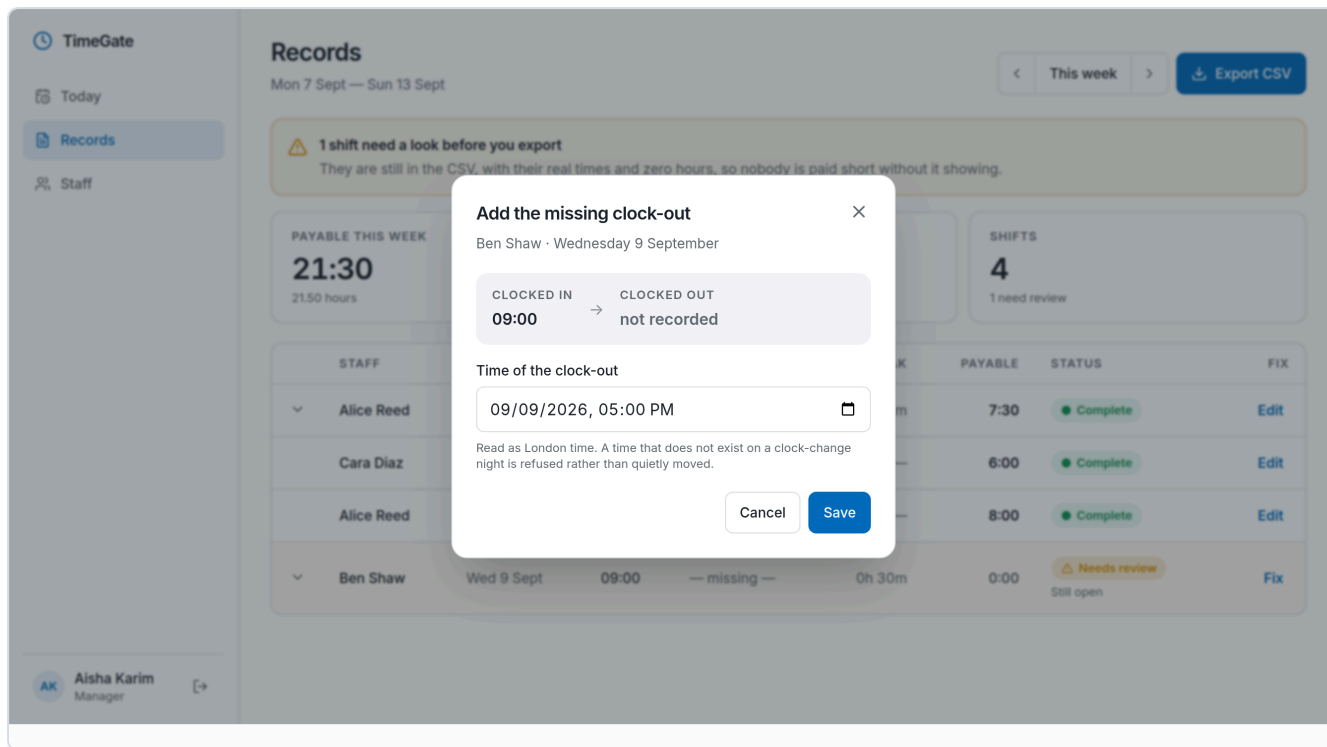
STAFF	DATE	IN	OUT	BREAK	PAYABLE	STATUS	FIX
▼ Alice Reed	Mon 7 Sept	09:00	17:00	0h 30m	7:30	Complete	Edit
Cara Diaz	Mon 7 Sept	10:00	16:00	—	6:00	Complete	Edit
Alice Reed	Tue 8 Sept	09:00	17:00	—	8:00	Complete	Edit
▼ Ben Shaw	Wed 9 Sept	09:00	— missing —	0h 30m	0:00	Needs review Still open	Fix

AK Aisha Karim

Manager

The Records screen. The flagged shift is the one that needs a decision from you.

Press **Fix**, enter the time that actually happened, and save. The totals update immediately.



Correcting a shift. Times are read as London time.

WHY ZERO AND NOT AN ESTIMATE

The system will not invent a clock-out time, because an invented time is an invented wage. Zero and a warning is a number you will notice. A plausible guess is one you will not.

A reviewed shift stays in the export either way, at zero hours with its status showing, so nobody is ever quietly paid short.

Paying people

Records → pick the week with the arrows → **Export CSV**.

One row per shift, with the payroll reference so it can be matched to your payroll system. Hours appear twice — as a decimal (7.75) and as hours and minutes (7:45) — because different systems want different ones.

BEFORE YOU EXPORT

Clear anything marked **Needs review**. The banner tells you how many. Exporting with them unresolved means those shifts pay zero.

Individual break times are on screen only, not in the export, so the file stays one row per shift and can be checked by hand.

TimeGate

Today

Records

Staff

Today

Monday 14 September

ON SHIFT

0

ON A BREAK

0

NOT IN

3

Who's here

STAFF	STATUS	SINCE	TODAY SO FAR
Alice Reed	Not in	—	4h 15m
Ben Shaw	Not in	—	—
Dana Okoro	Not in	—	—

Hours count finished shifts only, with breaks already deducted, so a shift in progress shows a dash.

AK

Aisha Karim

Manager

The Today screen shows who is on shift, on a break, or not in.

Installing it on a phone or tablet

TimeGate installs like an app, so it opens full-screen with no address bar.

- **Android / Chrome:** open the punch link, then the menu → *Install app* (or *Add to Home screen*). Chrome may also offer it by itself.
- **iPhone / Safari:** open the punch link, tap Share, then *Add to Home Screen*.

It is the same app either way — installing only changes how it opens. Nothing comes from an app store and there is nothing to update by hand.

If the wifi drops

The screen still opens without a connection, but it will say "**No connection — clocking in and out is paused**" and the keypad will not accept anything.

That is deliberate. It would be easy to let people tap away and save it up for later, and that is exactly how the wrong times get recorded. Nothing is stored, so nothing is stored wrong. Use pen and paper and enter it afterwards.

The tablet at the entrance

- Open the punch link and add it to the home screen.
- Turn on **screen pinning** (Android: Settings → Security → Screen pinning) so staff cannot wander into other apps.
- Set the screen timeout long, and keep it on charge.

TREAT THE PUNCH LINK LIKE A DOOR KEY

It is deliberately long and unguessable, and that is what keeps the 4-digit codes from being guessed by anyone who finds the site. Fine to give to staff. Not to put on a noticeboard.

If it stops working

Wifi down, tablet flat, site unreachable — fall back to **pen and paper**. Write down name, in, and out.

When it is back, add those shifts yourself through **Fix** on the Records screen. The result is identical to if they had been tapped in at the time.

Clock changes

The system handles the two nights a year when the clocks move. A 22:00–06:00 night shift is **7 hours** in spring when the clocks go forward and **9 hours** in autumn when they go back, and is paid that way, because that is how long people were actually there.

If you ever enter a time by hand that does not exist — 01:30 on the spring night — it will refuse it rather than move it quietly.

If you decide to keep it

This is currently running on a personal account on free hosting. That is fine for trying it out, and not where your payroll records should live long term.

Before it becomes the real system of record:

- 1 Move the hosting and the database to a company-owned account.
- 2 Decide how long you keep punch records, and who is allowed to see them.
- 3 Tell staff in writing what is recorded and why — clock-in, clock-out and break times are personal data.

Ask whoever set it up to do the move. It is a short job, but it should happen before this is the only record of anyone's hours.